

GlobalTrust Financial Services

VPN Access Guide

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1. Purpose

Secure remote access is essential for protecting GTFS banking systems, customer information, and internal resources. The Virtual Private Network (VPN) creates an encrypted tunnel between your device and the GTFS corporate network, ensuring that data in transit cannot be intercepted by unauthorised parties.

This guide provides step-by-step instructions for installing, configuring, and using the approved VPN client. All users must comply with the Information Security Policy (GTFS-SEC-001), Password & MFA Policy (GTFS-SEC-002), and Remote Work Policy (GTFS-HR-002).

DID YOU KNOW?: VPN access is logged and monitored. Connection logs are retained for 365 days per regulatory requirements.

2. Scope

- **Employees** — full-time and part-time staff with remote access entitlement.
- **Contractors** — approved external personnel with time-limited VPN profiles.
- **Approved Vendors** — third parties under signed security agreements.
- **Consultants** — advisory roles with scoped network access.
- **Remote Workers** — employees working primarily from home.
- **Hybrid Employees** — staff using VPN on non-office days per GTFS-HR-002.

3. Supported VPN Platforms

Supported Devices & Operating Systems

Platform	Minimum Version	Notes
Windows 11	22H2 or later	Primary corporate platform
macOS	Ventura (13.0) or later	Intel and Apple Silicon supported
Ubuntu Linux	22.04 LTS	Developer and engineering roles only
iOS	17.0 or later	Mobile access; limited resource availability
Android	13.0 or later	Mobile access; MDM enrollment required

IMPORTANT: A minimum internet speed of **20 Mbps** download is recommended for stable VPN performance.

4. Supported VPN Client

GTFS uses **Palo Alto GlobalProtect** as the approved enterprise VPN client. No other VPN software may be installed on GTFS-managed devices.

Feature	Specification
Protocol	IKEv2/IPSec

Feature	Specification
Encryption	AES-256
Authentication	Microsoft Entra ID + Microsoft Authenticator
Automatic updates	Managed by IT; user deferral prohibited
Always-On VPN	Enabled for administrators; optional for standard employees
Split tunneling	Disabled — all traffic routed through GTFS gateway
Device compliance	Required before every VPN connection

5. Before You Begin

Ensure you have the following before installing or connecting:

- GTFS company laptop (personal devices are not permitted for VPN).
- Active corporate email account (@gtfs.com or regional equivalent).
- Microsoft Authenticator enrolled per GTFS-SEC-002.
- Active employee or contractor account in good standing.
- Stable internet connection (minimum 20 Mbps recommended).
- Device passing compliance check (encryption, patches, EDR active).

SECURITY WARNING: MFA is mandatory for all VPN connections. You cannot connect without approving the Authenticator prompt on your registered device.

6. Installing the VPN Client

Step-by-Step Installation

Step 1 — Download

Open Software Center (Windows/macOS) or IT portal. Search for 'GlobalProtect'. Download the latest approved version.

Step 2 — Install

Run the installer with administrator privileges. Accept the GTFS security notice. Do not modify default settings.

Step 3 — Configure

Enter portal address: **vpn.gtfs.internal**. GlobalProtect retrieves configuration automatically.

Step 4 — Certificate

Verify the server certificate thumbprint matches the value published on the IT portal. Certificate renewal occurs every 12 months.

Step 5 — Login

Enter your GTFS email and password. Approve MFA prompt in Microsoft Authenticator.

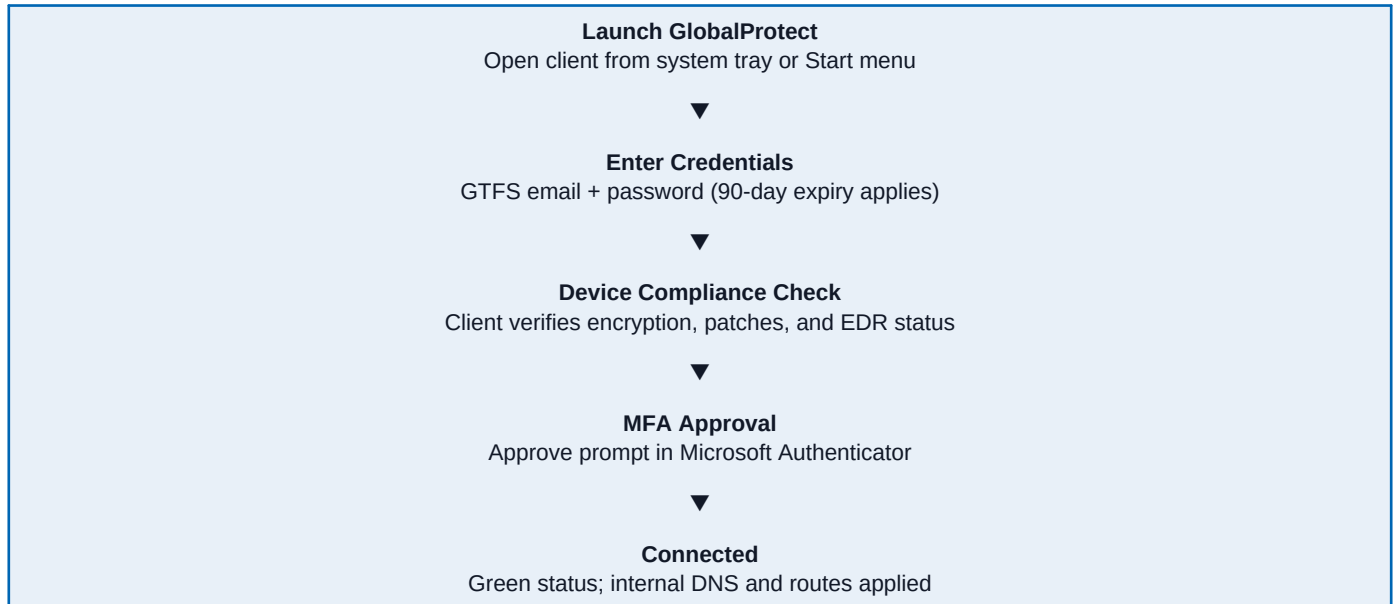
Step 6 — First Connection

Wait for 'Connected' status. Internal DNS servers are automatically assigned after connection.

[Screenshot: GlobalProtect Installation]

7. Connecting to GTFS Network

VPN Login Process



[Screenshot: VPN Login Screen]

[Screenshot: MFA Approval]

[Screenshot: Connected Successfully]

Once connected, access internal applications via their standard URLs (e.g., hr.gtfs.internal). To disconnect safely, click **Disconnect** in GlobalProtect before closing your laptop. Automatic reconnection is enabled after temporary network interruptions.

Connection Status Indicators

Status	Icon Colour	Meaning
Connected	Green	VPN tunnel active; internal resources reachable
Connecting	Yellow	Authentication or compliance check in progress
Disconnected	Grey	No active tunnel
Error	Red	Connection failed — see Section 11 Troubleshooting

8. VPN Security Requirements

- **MFA mandatory** — every connection requires Authenticator approval.
- **Company devices only** — personal laptops and phones are not permitted.
- **Device encryption** — AES-256 BitLocker or FileVault must be active.
- **Automatic updates** — pending critical patches block VPN connection.
- **Public Wi-Fi** — permitted only when VPN is active; prefer secure home networks.
- **Idle timeout** — VPN disconnects after 15 minutes of inactivity.
- **Session monitoring** — connections logged; maximum session duration 12 hours.

IMPORTANT: Maximum concurrent VPN sessions: **2** per user. A third connection attempt will terminate the oldest active session.

9. Access Levels

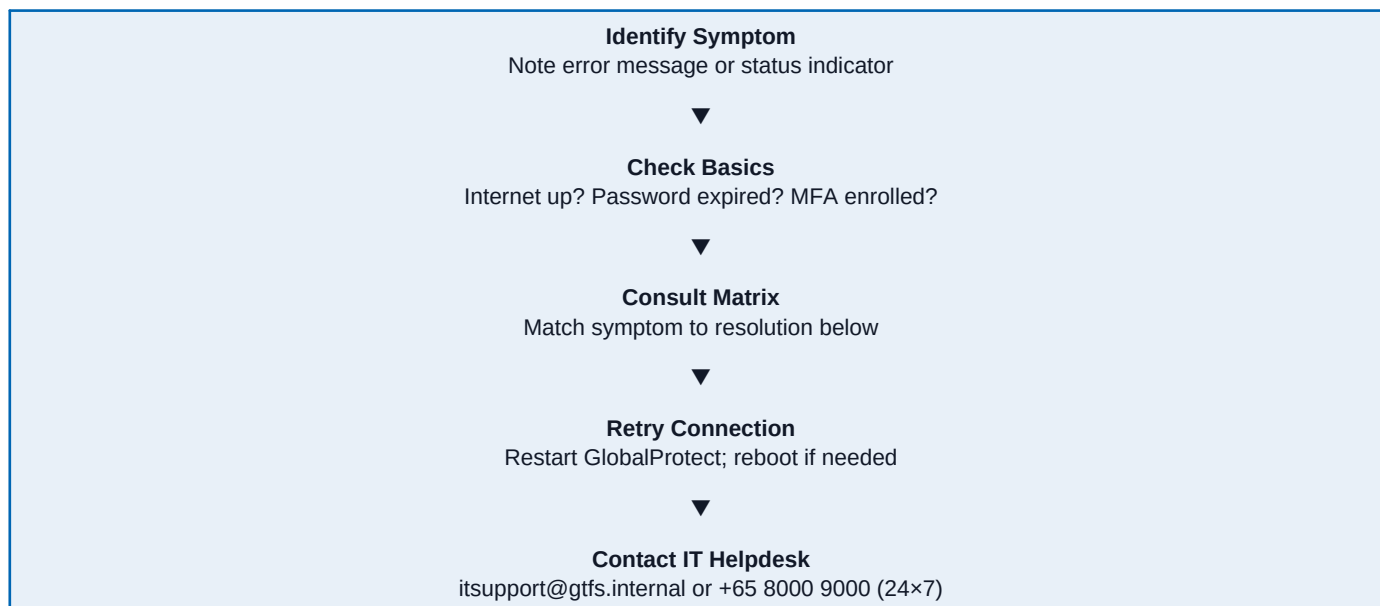
Role	Accessible Systems	Restrictions
Employee	Email, HR Portal, Knowledge Portal, Internal Wiki	Standard RBAC
Manager	Above + team dashboards, approval workflows	Department scope
Administrator	Above + Atlas admin, Risk Portal, infrastructure tools	Always-On VPN; PAM required
Contractor	Scoped per contract (typically email + project systems)	Limited profile
Vendor	Vendor portal only; no Atlas or customer data	Strictly limited VLAN

10. Network Resources Available

Resource	URL / Access Method	Availability
Corporate Email	Outlook / outlook.gtfs.com	All VPN users
HR Portal	hr.gtfs.internal	Employees and contractors
Loan Management System	lms.gtfs.internal	Retail and commercial banking
Atlas Core Banking Platform	atlas.gtfs.internal	Operations; role-based
Knowledge Portal (Project Phoenix)	phoenix.gtfs.internal	All employees
File Servers	\\files.gtfs.internal	Department shares
Internal Wiki	wiki.gtfs.internal	All employees
Customer Support Dashboard	support.gtfs.internal	Contact centre staff
Risk Portal	risk.gtfs.internal	Risk and compliance teams

11. Troubleshooting

Troubleshooting Workflow



Troubleshooting Matrix

Issue	Likely Cause	Resolution
Cannot connect	Compliance check failed	Run Windows Update; verify BitLocker active
MFA failure	Authenticator not enrolled	Re-enroll per GTFS-SEC-002 Appendix B
Certificate expired	Client cert past 12-month renewal	Contact IT Helpdesk for reissue
Slow VPN	Internet below 20 Mbps	Use wired connection; close streaming apps
DNS problems	Split tunnel misconfiguration	Disconnect/reconnect; DNS auto-assigned
Internet unavailable	Local ISP outage	Use mobile hotspot; VPN reconnects automatically
Password expired	90-day rotation due	Reset via self-service portal with MFA
Account locked	5 failed login attempts	Wait 30 minutes or contact IT Helpdesk

TROUBLESHOOTING TIP: If you see error code GP-1001, verify your device passes the compliance check. Error GP-2003 indicates MFA timeout — approve the prompt within 60 seconds.

12. Security Best Practices

- Never share VPN credentials or approve MFA prompts you did not initiate.
- Disconnect VPN when finished working, especially on shared networks.
- Lock your computer (Windows+L) when stepping away, even with VPN active.
- Report suspicious VPN activity or unexpected MFA prompts to security@gtfs.com.
- Never use public or hotel computers to access GTFS VPN.
- Keep GlobalProtect and operating system updated via Software Center.

BEST PRACTICE: Emergency VPN issues outside business hours: call the IT Helpdesk hotline **+65 8000 9000** — available 24×7.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What VPN client does GTFS use? A: Palo Alto GlobalProtect.

Q: What protocol and encryption? A: IKEv2/IPSec with AES-256 encryption.

Q: How do I authenticate? A: Microsoft Entra ID credentials plus Microsoft Authenticator MFA.

Q: Is MFA required for VPN? A: Yes. MFA is mandatory for every connection.

Q: What is the VPN idle timeout? A: 15 minutes of inactivity.

Q: What is the maximum session duration? A: 12 hours; reconnect after timeout.

Q: How many VPN sessions can I have? A: Maximum 2 concurrent sessions per user.

Q: What happens after 5 failed logins? A: Account locks for 30 minutes.

Q: Is split tunneling enabled? A: No. Split tunneling is disabled for all users.

Q: Do administrators have Always-On VPN? A: Yes. Always-On VPN is enabled for administrators.

Q: How often are certificates renewed? A: Every 12 months.

Q: What OS versions are supported? A: Windows 11, macOS Ventura+, Ubuntu 22.04 LTS, iOS 17+, Android 13+.

Q: What internet speed do I need? A: Minimum 20 Mbps recommended.

Q: When is IT Helpdesk available? A: 24×7 via itsupport@gtfs.internal or +65 8000 9000.

Q: How long are VPN logs kept? A: 365 days.

Q: When does my password expire? A: Every 90 days per GTFS-SEC-002.

Q: What is checked before I connect? A: Device compliance: encryption, patches, and EDR status.

Q: Does VPN reconnect automatically? A: Yes, after temporary network interruptions.

Q: Are internal DNS servers assigned automatically? A: Yes, after successful connection.

Q: Where is the remote work policy? A: GTFS-HR-002 covers hybrid and remote VPN obligations.

14. Appendices

Appendix A — Connection Checklist

- Company laptop with GlobalProtect installed
- Internet connection (20 Mbps+ recommended)
- Microsoft Authenticator enrolled and working
- Password not expired (90-day cycle)
- Device compliance check passing
- VPN portal: vpn.gtfs.internal

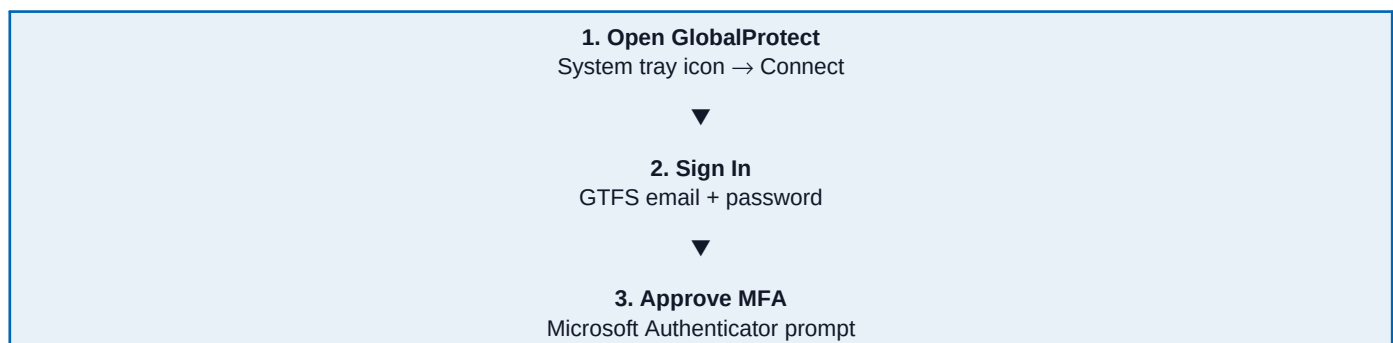
Appendix B — IT Helpdesk Contacts

Channel	Contact	Hours
Email	itsupport@gtfs.internal	24×7
Phone	+65 8000 9000	24×7
Self-Service Portal	helpdesk.gtfs.internal	24×7
Emergency Hotline	+65 8000 9000	24×7

Appendix C — VPN Error Codes

Code	Description	Action
GP-1001	Device compliance failed	Update OS; verify encryption and EDR
GP-1002	Certificate validation error	Contact IT Helpdesk for cert renewal
GP-2001	Authentication failed	Verify credentials; check password expiry
GP-2003	MFA timeout	Approve Authenticator prompt within 60 seconds
GP-3001	Maximum sessions exceeded	Disconnect oldest session; max 2 allowed
GP-4001	Gateway unreachable	Check internet; retry in 5 minutes

Appendix D — Quick Start Guide



**4. Verify Green Status**

Connected — access internal resources

**5. Disconnect When Done**

Click Disconnect before closing laptop

Password Reset Process (VPN-Related)

Password Expired

VPN login fails with GP-2001

**Self-Service Reset**

password.gtfs.internal with MFA

**Reconnect VPN**

New password + Authenticator approval

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